Lok Sabha Background Guide



Letter From The Executive Board

Dear Prospective Members,

At the outset, on behalf of the Executive Board, we warmly welcome you and congratulate you on being part of the Lok Sabha simulation at the Silver Oaks Model United Nations Conference (SOMUN 2026).

The committee being simulated, unlike most other simulations you may have been part of or heard of, shall focus on political intellect, logical intellect, the analytical application of thought, and the strategic application

of thought in addressing the issue(s) at hand. This committee will be bilingual **(English and Hindi; if any other languages are used, translation must be provided),** especially for slogans and remarks. The documentation must be **only in English**.

Kindly note that we are not looking for existing (read: impractical) solutions or copy-paste statements; instead, we seek a creative/unconventional solution from you, given the impending limitations of the person and the politics you represent. Given the extremely political and volatile nature of this committee's agenda, we, as the **Executive Board**, will be looking to test your presence of mind and analytical aptitude.

Kindly do not limit your research to the areas highlighted below, but ensure that you logically deduce and push your research into areas associated with the issues mentioned. Do note, however, that the agenda is only one element of the committee and covers about half of your preparation. It is imperative that you be well prepared with the general political updates.

Important: In this committee, we will be revamping the entire Rules of Procedure and aligning them as closely as reasonably possible with the real proceedings of the Lok Sabha. A brief RoP (Rules of Procedure) guide shall be explained to you during the first Session of the conference. As part of the new procedures, or should we rather say the 'real procedures,' only 30 to 40% of the committee time shall be utilised to discuss the predetermined agenda. The majority of the revised RoP shall be borrowed from the ‘Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in Lok Sabha (17th Edition, 2024)’.

As a result, your general political awareness and your detailed awareness of issues about your state and constituency in particular are pivotal, as they could become topics of discussion in the committee. We therefore urge you to keep yourself updated with the latest national, regional, state, and constituency-level political developments (of the MP you are representing). Without this, it will be extremely difficult to manage the committee's pace and expectations.

Another place where members usually make errors is in understanding their stance and approach towards an issue, and towards other members, in correlation with their political party and its ideology.

Please note: being political and being in sync with the stance of your party in general while keeping in mind the person you are representing is non-negotiable. Yes, we do not want a replica of the person; rather, we want to see a better version of the person, while keeping the individual and political limitations and realities in place.

Kindly note that, unlike most conventional or unconventional committees you have attended, this committee shall have substantial "substantive" intervention by the Executive Board.

The objective of this background guide is to provide you with a 'background' to the issue(s) at hand, and therefore it might seem to some as not being comprehensive enough.

We are sure, however, that this background guide will be a perfect launch pad for your research. But please ensure that this is not your only research. This guide deals only with a skeletal overview of the agenda and its ancillary aspects. You may carry your laptops or tablets, which may be permitted to be used at the discretion of the Executive Board. It is imperative to follow this guideline. Non-adherence to this rule will result in immediate suspension from the committee. There is a **zero-tolerance**

policy towards Internet usage during committee proceedings unless we **explicitly permit** the same. Attendance in all substantive committee sessions is a qualifying criterion for awards, in addition to other benchmarks that might be stipulated in the Committee Guidelines below.

Executive Board,
Lok Sabha-SOMUN 2026.

Basic Information:

Duration of the Session: 3 Days

Date of the Session: Real time (Days of the Conference)

Nature of Business: Discussion on a Matter of Public Interest u/r 184 read along with r/190.

Matter of Discussion: Consideration of the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024, providing for simultaneous elections to the House of the People and the Legislative Assemblies of the States (‘One Nation, One Election’), and recommendation of appropriate constitutional, operational, and federal safeguards.

Scope for Private Members' Business: No.

Committee Guidelines

Key Pointers To Note:

1. The Lok Sabha is primarily a legislative committee. That said, it cannot be converted into a highly technical legal committee per se in terms of your approach, an issue we mostly encounter in simulations at MUNs and YPs.
2. Sloganeering, walkouts and other such over-dramatic political manoeuvres, while not recommended, may be executed but ought to be within the bounds of the Rules of Business of the Lok Sabha.
3. The simulation of the Lok Sabha is meant to reflect a better version of the MP you are representing, not a replica, keeping in mind the individual and political-ideological limitations.
4. Be well-versed in current affairs, news, and political movements within or related to the country, and be thorough with your portfolio's political stance and ideology and the party ideology in general.
5. The committee shall be bilingual, i.e, English and Hindi. If any other languages are used in the committee, translation for the same must be provided.
6. Any kind of Documentation submitted or presented in the committee must be in English only.

Background Guide

Agenda of the committee:

Consideration of the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024, providing for simultaneous elections to the House of the People and the Legislative Assemblies of the States (‘One Nation, One Election’), and recommendation of appropriate constitutional, operational, and federal safeguards.

Introduction

India, being the world’s largest democracy, has 3major elections-

1. General/ National Elections
2. State Assembly Elections
3. Panchayat/ Local Elections

The National Elections in the country are conducted every five years unless there is a premature dissolution due to any kind of instability. Elections in India do not occur at one fixed time. Lok Sabha elections, State Assembly elections, municipal elections and Panchayat elections are generally conducted at different times. As a result, some parts of the country are frequently preparing for an election.

According to the Government of India’s Press Information Bureau, holding elections repeatedly requires separate spending on polling personnel, security, EVMs/VVPATs, transport and other logistics required to carry out an election in the country. This “incessant” (read: frequent) election phase further adds to the government's financial burden and, at the same time, hinders the fulfilment of manifestos. Frequent campaigning also diverts ministers, legislators, officials, and civil servants' attention from policy implementation and public services.

Therefore, the Government put forward the proposal popularly known as "One Nation, One Election (ONOE)". It seeks to change this system by establishing a framework under which elections to the House of the People and the Legislative Assemblies of the States would be held simultaneously. The Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 17 December 2024 and has been referred to a Joint Parliamentary Committee for detailed examination.

On the other hand, the Opposition parties are not fully supporting One Nation, One Election because they have concerns about how it might affect the balance of power between the Centre and the states. They worry that a common election schedule could make national issues more prominent than local ones and may not suit situations where governments change unexpectedly. Some also feel it could reduce political accountability and create advantages for larger parties, while regional parties may have less space to raise their own issues.

The 129th Constitution Amendment Bill, 2024 has brought renewed attention to the idea of One Nation, One Election in India. While some view simultaneous elections as a way to streamline the electoral process and

improve governance, others question its wider implications for the country's political and constitutional framework.

One Nation One Election (ONOE)

One Nation, One Election is a proposal to hold elections to the Lok Sabha and the State Legislative Assemblies during the same electoral cycle. It does not necessarily mean that every election in India, including municipal and Panchayat elections, would take place on the same day. The main idea is that voters could elect their Lok Sabha representative and their State Assembly representative at the same time, creating a common electoral cycle for the country.

However, this would not mean that governments automatically receive unlimited five-year terms. One of the most important questions is what would happen if the Lok Sabha or a State Assembly is dissolved before completing its normal term. The proposed framework suggests that a newly elected legislature, formed after a dissolution, would serve only the remaining period of the existing common electoral cycle. This aspect raises several questions about representation, stability, and the functioning of democracy, which delegates are encouraged to examine as they develop their positions.

The 129th Amendment Bill supplements the implementation of ONOE in the country. The President may issue a notification on the date of the first sitting of Lok Sabha after a general election. All State Assemblies constituted after this

date will expire at the end of that Lok Sabha's five-year term. If Lok Sabha or a State Assembly is dissolved earlier than its five-year term, an election for it will be held for a term equal to the remainder of the five-year term. This will synchronise its next election with the simultaneous elections cycle. If the ECI believes that an election to a State Assembly cannot be held as part of the simultaneous elections, it may make a recommendation to the President in this regard. The President may issue an order to conduct elections for that Assembly at a later date.

Note: The Bill provides for holding elections to the Union Territory Assemblies as part of the simultaneous elections.

History of ONOE

India's first general election in 1951–52 was held simultaneously for the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies. This continued through the next three general elections, until 1967. The system broke down in the late 1960s and early 1970s due to premature dissolutions(State Assemblies were dissolved before completing their terms), after which national and state elections began taking place at different times. Therefore, simultaneous elections were historically part of India's electoral system. The Fourth Lok Sabha was also dissolved prematurely in 1970.

Timelines of key milestones of various Lok Sabhas-

Lok Sabha	Last date of poll	Date of constitution of Lok Sabha	Date of first sitting	Date of expiration of term (Article 83(2) of Constitution	Date of dissolution of Lok Sabha	Overall Term (in days) (Col 6 - Col 4)	Overall Term (approx)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
First	21-Feb-52	2-Apr-52	13-May-52	12-May-57	4-Apr-57	1787	5 years
Second	15-Mar-57	5-Apr-57	10-May-57	9-May-62	31-Mar-62	1786	5 years
Third	25-Feb-62	2-Apr-62	16-Apr-62	15-Apr-67	3-Mar-67	1782	5 years
Fourth	21-Feb-67	4-Mar-67	16-Mar-67	15-Mar-72	27-Dec-70	1382*	3 years & 10 months
Fifth	10-Mar-71	15-Mar-71	19-Mar-71	18-Mar-77	18-Jan-77	2132**	5 years & 10 months
Sixth	20-Mar-77	23-Mar-77	25-Mar-77	24-Mar-82	22-Aug-79	880*	2 years & 5 months
Seventh	6-Jan-80	10-Jan-80	21-Jan-80	20-Jan-85	31-Dec-84	1806	5 years
Eighth	28-Dec-84	31-Dec-84	15-Jan-85	14-Jan-90	27-Nov-89	1777	5 years
Ninth	26-Nov-89	2-Dec-89	18-Dec-89	17-Dec-94	13-Mar-91	450*	1 year & 3 months
Tenth	15-Jun-91	20-Jun-91	9-Jul-91	8-Jul-96	10-May-96	1767	5 years
Eleventh	7-May-96	15-May-96	22-May-96	21-May-01	4-Dec-97	561*	1 year & 6 months
Twelfth	7-Mar-98	10-Mar-98	23-Mar-98	22-Mar-03	26-Apr-99	399*	1 year & 1 month
Thirteenth	4-Oct-99	10-Oct-99	20-Oct-99	19-Oct-04	6-Feb-04	1570*	4 years & 4 months

This system began to unravel after the general elections of 1967. That year marked a major political shift in Indian history. For the first time, the Indian National Congress faced significant losses in many states. While the Congress managed to retain power at the Centre with a reduced majority, it suffered significant setbacks in several states, losing control in nine, including Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Punjab, West Bengal, and Tamil Nadu. This election saw the rise of opposition alliances and regional parties like the DMK, which became the first regional party to form a government in Tamil Nadu. These non-Congress governments were often fragile coalitions, plagued by internal conflicts and ideological differences, leading to premature dissolutions of many state assemblies. As a result, elections began to be held at different times in different states, breaking the cycle of simultaneous elections that had existed since 1951–52. The 1967 elections thus marked the beginning of coalition politics in India and permanently altered the country's electoral rhythm.

In short, simultaneous elections were once India's norm, ended because of political instability and early dissolutions, and have re-entered national debate through successive expert reports and the current constitutional amendment proposal.

The original cycle broke due to political instability and internal factionalism. One Nation, One Election was discontinued after 1967 mainly because governments at both the state and national levels began falling before completing their five-year terms, which caused elections to be held at different times and gradually broke the common electoral cycle. Some State Legislative Assemblies were dissolved prematurely in 1968 and 1969, and later, in 1970, the fourth Lok Sabha was also dissolved before completing its term. As a result, their election schedules no longer matched. After the 1967 elections, several states saw coalition governments with narrow majorities, and these governments often collapsed due to shifting alliances, defections, and no-confidence motions, leading to fresh elections. The frequent use of Article 356, which allows President's Rule in a state, also contributed to the dissolution or suspension of State Assemblies, further disturbing the election calendar. In addition, hung assemblies and political instability increased the chances of early dissolutions and fresh elections. After the initial break in 1968 and 1969, each premature dissolution created a new election date, and over time these separate cycles became permanent, leading India to move to the present pattern where Lok Sabha and State Assembly elections are held on different schedules. Therefore, ONOE was not formally abolished; rather, it gradually ended because India's political system became more competitive.

Legal Scaffolding of ONOE

The legal basis for One Nation, One Election is the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024. It seeks to amend the Constitution to enable simultaneous elections for the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.

Main legal provisions

- **New Article 82A:** This proposed article would empower the Election Commission of India to conduct general elections to the Lok Sabha and all State Legislative Assemblies simultaneously.
- **Amendment to Article 83:** This article deals with the duration of the Lok Sabha. The Bill would allow a newly elected Lok Sabha, after premature dissolution, to serve only the remaining part of the original five-year term.
- **Amendment to Article 172:** This article deals with the duration of State Legislative Assemblies. It would be similarly amended so that an Assembly elected after early dissolution serves the unexpired portion of the common cycle.
- **Amendment to Article 327:** This provision would include the conduct of simultaneous elections among matters on which Parliament may make law relating to elections.

Comparative International examples of the ONOE model-

Countries like South Africa, Sweden, Indonesia, and Belgium conduct national and regional elections simultaneously. These nations benefit from more centralised political systems or simplified electoral calendars. India’s federalism, linguistic diversity, and asymmetric legislative tenures make direct emulation difficult.

Stance of Major Parties on ONOE

The Opponents-

These groups are strongly against the initiative. Their main concern is that local identities, regional languages and state-level issues will be completely ignored because of national campaigns.

• Congress: They are the group against it. The party says the plan is an attack on the Constitution and believes it will harm India's federal system by taking away power from the states.

• DMK: Led by M. K. Stalin in Tamil Nadu, this party is one of the critics. They say the plan is a way to make India like the United States with a presidential system that would ignore Tamil culture and rights. They also say buying millions of voting machines will cost too much.

• Samajwadi Party: Akhilesh Yadav says the idea is a path to dictatorship. He believes trying to make everything the same goes against a country that's so diverse. He even told the government to dissolve Parliament right away if they really want to have a synchronised vote.

• Trinamool Congress: Mamata Banerjee says there is a problem with the plan. She asks what happens if a state government fails in its year. Under this system, that state might have to be controlled by New Delhi for four *years until the national schedule starts again. She says that takes away the right to vote.*

• Aam Aadmi Party: They say the whole idea is not possible for a country as big and different as India.

• Left Parties: The CPI(M) and other left groups say changing the time of a state assembly's five-year term to match a schedule in New Delhi is an insult to the people who voted for those leaders.

• TVK: The new party in Tamil Nadu led by Vijay has also rejected the idea. They say it is against democracy.

The Ruling-

These parties say India is stuck in a never-ending election cycle. They believe constant voting uses much public money, stops development and keeps police and teachers busy during elections.

• BJP: As the group pushing the plan, they say synchronised elections will save thousands of crores. They believe it will stop the problems caused by elections and let governments focus on long-term projects.

• TDP and Janata Dal (United): As parts of the ruling coalition, Chandrababu Naidu and Nitish Kumar fully support the plan to make the government work better and be more efficient.

• Shiv Sena (Shinde) and NCP (Ajit Pawar): Both of these groups from Maharashtra support the plan. They agree it will save a lot of state money.

• YSR Congress Party: Jagan Mohan Reddy's party supports it because it is practical. Andhra Pradesh already votes for its state assembly and the Lok Sabha at the same time, so they are used to it and think it makes sense.

• Biju Janata Dal: Naveen Patnaik's party in Odisha has supported the idea for a time. Their state also holds national elections at the same time.

The difference is clear. The opposition sees the plan as a way for the centre to take power and harm state independence. The ruling group and some other local parties see it as a way to save money and make things work better.

Delimitation Bill, 2026

The Delimitation Bill, 2026 was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 16 April 2026 as part of a legislative package with the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026. The Bill failed to secure the required majority on its motion for consideration in April 2026, and the related Bills did not proceed. It seeks to constitute a Delimitation Commission to readjust and reallocate Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assembly seats, redraw constituency boundaries, and determine seats reserved for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and women. The Bill also proposes to repeal the Delimitation Act, 2002.The proposed Commission would be chaired by a serving or former Supreme Court judge and include the Chief Election Commissioner or a nominated Election Commissioner, along with the concerned State Election Commissioner. Each state would have ten associate

members, five from its Lok Sabha MPs and five from its Legislative Assembly, nominated by the respective Speakers, though they would not have voting rights. Delimitation would be based on the latest published census available when the Commission is constituted, which in practice would be the 2011 Census.

A key change is that the Constitution currently freezes the allocation of Lok Sabha seats among states based on the 1971 Census, extended by the 84th Constitutional Amendment in 2001 until the first census after 2026. The new proposal would restore allocation in proportion to population and increase the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha from 550 to 850 members, with up to 815 from states and 35 from union territories. The Bill is closely linked to the 106th Constitutional Amendment, 2023, which provides for reservation of one-third of seats for women in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies. The new delimitation exercise would enable this reservation to be implemented by identifying the seats to be reserved for women.

Conclusion

One Nation, One Election is not simply a question of whether elections should be held on the same day. It is a question about the structure of Indian democracy.

Supporters see ONOE as an opportunity to reduce administrative disruption, improve governance, reduce repeated election expenditure and create a predictable electoral cycle. Opponents see significant risks involving federalism, State autonomy, democratic accountability, regional political representation and the constitutional consequences of premature dissolution.

Both sides raise legitimate constitutional questions. The success of any ONOE framework would therefore depend not only on synchronising elections but on the safeguards surrounding the system. Rather than adopting broad positions for or against the proposal, they should develop practical, innovative, and unique solutions that address the concerns of both the Union and the states. The strength of the debate will depend on delegates' ability to move beyond ideology and propose workable mechanisms that protect democratic values while responding to India's electoral and governance challenges.

Bibliography

- https://www.pib.gov.in/allRel.aspx?reg=48&lang=1 **(Press Information Bureau)**
- https://prsindia.org/ **(PRS Legislative Research)**
- https://sansad.in/ls **(Digital Sansad, Loksabha Library)**
- The Hindu, The Indian Express, PTI and The Times of India **(Not for legal or factual proof)**

Important Note: *This background is just for your reference in understanding the agenda and cannot be used as a source/proof in the committee.*

The documentation to be submitted shall be further elaborated in the Committee session.

The rules of procedure and committee flow on the first day of the conference will be explained by the executive board.
